

Canadian Household Spending Analysis

Comparative Core (2017, 2019, 2021) with 2023 Official Bridge

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Project Stage: Comparative Analysis and Sector Case Studies

Source: Statistics Canada — SHS PUMF 2017, 2019, 2021

Kernel: Python (shs2021)

Research Focus: Comparative household spending patterns, quintile pressure, provincial disparities, sector deep dives in Food & Consumer and Insurance, and 2023 Official Bridge post-COVID structural update

Project Purpose

This project analyzes how Canadian households changed their spending between 2017 and 2021 using the Survey of Household Spending Public Use Microdata File (SHS PUMF), with a 2023 official aggregate bridge added as a post-2021 contextual extension. The focus is on differences across provinces, income groups, and tenure types, with particular attention to shelter, food, transport, and selected insurance-related categories. The goal is to understand where financial pressure is concentrated, how that pressure changed across the comparative core years, and what the official 2023 aggregate results suggest about post-2021 spending structure.

This matters because affordability in Canada is often discussed in broad national terms. That kind of summary can miss important differences between households. A low-income renter in a high-cost province may face a very different reality from a higher-income homeowner, even though both are part of the same national average. By comparing provinces, income quintiles, and tenure groups across three survey years, this project aims to more clearly show those differences and support discussion of housing pressure, food burden, consumer behaviour, and social vulnerability in Canada.

Research Question

Why do Canadian household spending patterns vary across provinces, income quintiles, and tenure groups, and how did those differences evolve between 2017, 2019, and 2021, particularly in food and insurance?

Executive Summary

Between 2017 and 2021, average household income in Canada climbed from \$84,689 to \$103,048 — a number that, on its own, sounds like progress, and in some ways it was. But when you look past that headline figure, the story gets more complicated. Shelter costs kept rising throughout the period, food spending jumped sharply heading into 2019, and never really came back down. While transport spending did drop in 2021, that drop had more to do with pandemic-era behaviour than any structural improvement in affordability.

It is important to note that, although the monetary values in this report are presented in nominal dollars and are not inflation-adjusted, the report remains valuable because its main contribution is the identification of structural differences in spending burden across income groups, tenure types, and provinces, rather than a purely inflation-adjusted trend analysis.

The main problem is that national averages hide as much as they reveal. For households at the bottom of the income distribution, the period looked nothing like the aggregate trend. Families in the lowest income quintile — the bottom 20% — were spending more on shelter, food, and transport combined than their entire reported income in both 2017 and 2019, with those three categories absorbing 101.0% and 106.5% of income, respectively. By 2021, that figure had eased to 90.9%, an improvement, but still meant nine out of every ten dollars earned went to just those three essentials before anything else was paid.

The contrast with higher-income households is stark. For the top quintile, that same combined burden sat between 28% and 34% across the three years, leaving the majority of their income free for everything else. That gap, and what drives it, is what this report is really about.

Comparative Executive Summary Table

Year	Avg Income	Avg Shelter	Top Province Shelter Burden	Q1 Shelter Burden	Q1 Essential Burden	Renter Shelter Burden	
2017	\$84,689	\$18,207	British Columbia	53.6%	101.0%	26.5%	
2019	\$92,883	\$19,716	British Columbia	55.1%	106.5%	26.2%	
2021	\$103,048	\$20,457	British Columbia	48.0%	90.9%	24.0%	

Table 1. Comparative executive summary indicators

1. Introduction

This report analyzes household spending patterns in Canada using the Survey of Household Spending Public Use Microdata File (SHS PUMF) for 2017, 2019, and 2021. The goal is not simply to compare average spending levels, but to explain how pressure differs across income groups, tenure groups, provinces, and sectors. That distinction matters because a national average can improve even while large segments of the population remain under persistent stress.

The report synthesizes a comparative core analysis together with two sector-specific case studies. The comparative core establishes national, provincial, quintile, and tenure patterns. The sector chapters deepen the interpretation through Food & Consumer and Insurance — the two areas that received the strongest analytical development in this project.

The 2017–2021 window spans the pre-COVID baseline (2017), the pre-COVID peak pressure year (2019), and a COVID-affected recovery year (2021). This framing is essential to interpreting the data correctly: not all changes observed in 2021 reflect structural shifts; some reflect the specific conditions of pandemic-era household behaviour. To preserve methodological clarity, the report treats 2017, 2019, and 2021 as the comparative microdata core and 2023 as an official post-2021 bridge based on published aggregate results. This allows the analysis to extend the narrative beyond the COVID-affected 2021 year without overstating the symmetry of the available data sources.

2. Background and Research Context

Household spending gives a concrete picture of affordability, vulnerability, and consumer behaviour. Shelter, food, and transport together define the room households have left after essential needs are met — what this report calls residual income. How these burdens are distributed matters for policy analysis, market interpretation, and social vulnerability research.

Canada’s housing market has been under structural pressure since well before the COVID-19 period. The surge in average incomes observed between 2017 and 2021 reflects partly real wage and transfer gains, and partly the composition of who was captured in the survey in a year when many lower-income households faced unusual disruption. The food sector experienced a structural demand shift during COVID-19, with restaurant spending suppressed and grocery spending elevated. Insurance markets expanded their visible household footprint across the period, though the data also reflects changes in survey coverage between 2017 and later years.

Because 2021 was still affected by COVID-era conditions, the period should be read as 2017 baseline, 2019 pre-COVID peak pressure, and 2021 partial post-shift reference year rather than as a simple linear trend.

3. Methodology

The report uses the Statistics Canada Survey of Household Spending PUMF for 2017, 2019, and 2021. Each year was cleaned separately and then harmonized into a comparative core using the real cleaned datasets and bootstrap confidence interval outputs. The comparative core estimates household averages and burden ratios for income, shelter, food, transport, and health at the national, provincial, income quintile, and tenure levels.

The three reference years selected for this project — 2017, 2019, and 2021 — correspond to the only publicly available cycles of the Survey of Household Spending Public Use Microdata File (SHS PUMF). Statistics Canada releases the SHS as a biennial survey starting with 2017, but the PUMF — the anonymized microdata file accessible to the public for independent analysis — has only been released for these three cycles as of April 2026. The SHS 2023 cycle has been conducted and its aggregate results published, but its PUMF has not yet been made publicly available. The 2017–2021 window, therefore, represents the most complete and current public dataset accessible for this type of household-level analysis.

Income quintiles divide households into five equally sized income groups from Q1 (the lowest 20%) to Q5 (the highest 20%). This report uses quintiles because they reveal how the same national economy can generate very different spending burdens depending on household position in the income distribution.

Quintile	Definition
Q1 - Lowest	Lowest 20% of households by income
Q2	Second 20%
Q3	Middle 20%
Q4	Fourth 20%
Q5 - Highest	Highest 20% of households by income

Table 2. Income quintile definition - income groups

The report relies on survey weights embedded in the cleaned files. Bootstrap outputs were used to estimate 95% confidence intervals for selected shelter burden indicators. For example, Q1 shelter burden had a 95% CI of 48.2–59.0% in 2017, 51.4–58.8% in 2019, and 43.2%–52.8% in 2021. British Columbia consistently showed the highest shelter burden, with 95% CIs of 22.4–27.1% (2017), 23.6–26.4% (2019), and 21.7–24.9% (2021).

The 2017 SHS file differs from later years in two important ways. First, the project uses the 2017 Diary file because it contains the required expenditure variables with survey weights. Second, the Atlantic provinces are grouped under a single code in the 2017 PUMF, making detailed Atlantic province comparisons not fully equivalent to 2019 and 2021. Additionally, some sector variables in 2017 — notably private health and dental (HC061) and vehicle insurance (TR085) — are not available as separate line items, which must be acknowledged when interpreting the insurance findings.

Although the monetary values in this report are not inflation-adjusted, the report still provides substantial analytical value for three main reasons. First, its core contribution lies in burden ratios and structural comparisons across income quintiles, tenure groups, and provinces, which remain highly informative even when dollar values are reported in nominal terms. Second, the report is based on weighted household-level microdata from the Statistics Canada SHS PUMF and therefore captures meaningful differences in affordability pressure that national averages often hide. Third, the main

findings focus on relative inequality and spending pressure rather than on making a pure real-dollar trend claim about purchasing power over time.

Finally, the analysis was conducted primarily in Python using Jupyter Notebook for data cleaning, harmonization, weighted calculations, bootstrap confidence intervals, and comparative visualizations.

3.X 2023 Official Bridge — Methodological Note

In addition to the 2017, 2019, and 2021 SHS PUMF comparative core, this report includes a limited 2023 official bridge based on published Statistics Canada aggregate tables rather than public microdata. This distinction is important. The comparative core is built from weighted household-level SHS PUMF files, which allow quintile analysis, tenure analysis, burden calculations using household income, and bootstrap confidence intervals. By contrast, the 2023 extension relies on official aggregate summary tables and therefore does not reproduce the same microdata structure.

As a result, the 2023 bridge is analytically useful but not a perfect like-for-like continuation of the 2017–2021 comparative core. It is strongest for national expenditure levels, food, shelter, and transport structure, food channel split (stores versus restaurants), and provincial spending pattern comparisons. It does not reproduce 2023 quintile analysis, tenure analysis, or bootstrap confidence intervals at the same level as the PUMF-based years.

Unless otherwise stated, all monetary values in this report are presented in nominal dollars for their respective survey years and are not inflation-adjusted. Therefore, year-to-year changes in dollar amounts reflect both household spending behaviour and general price-level changes.

4. Findings and Analysis

4.1 General Household Spending Patterns, 2017–2021

At the national level, average household income rose from \$84,689 in 2017 to \$92,883 in 2019 and \$103,048 in 2021 — a 21.7% increase over the period. Average shelter spending rose from \$18,207 to \$19,716 and then to \$20,457. Food spending rose sharply from \$8,529 to \$10,318 between 2017 and 2019, and then remained essentially flat at \$10,306 in 2021. Transport spending stayed high in 2017 and 2019 at \$12,972 and \$12,874, respectively, then fell to \$10,289 in 2021. The national essential burden of shelter, food, and transport moved from 46.9% in 2017 to 46.2% in 2019 and down to 39.8% in 2021, while residual income rose from \$44,981 to \$61,997.

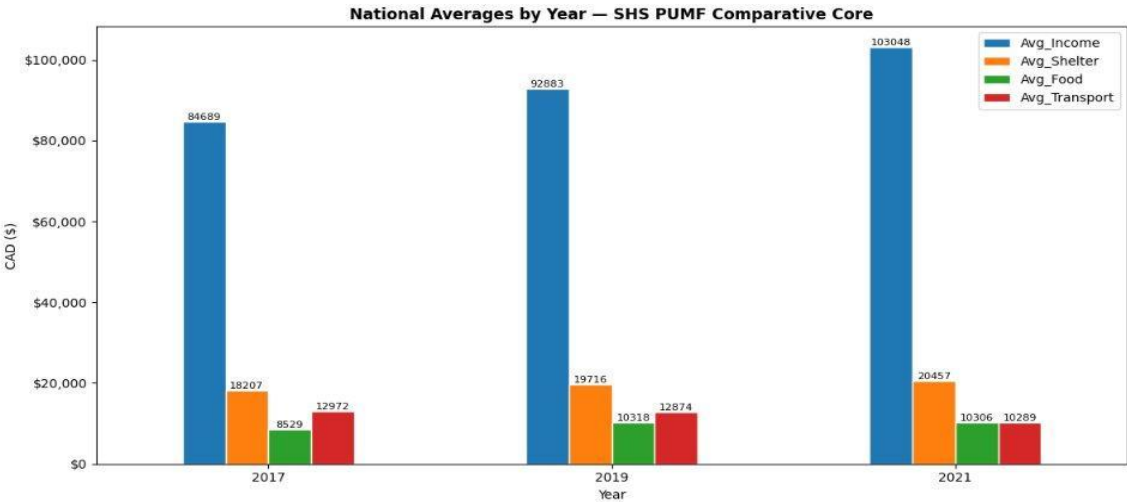


Figure 1. National averages by year — income, shelter, food, and transport (CAD)

Income Quintile Analysis

The national improvement masks a strong distributional divide. For Q1, the essential burden reached 101.0% of income in 2017 and 106.5% in 2019, meaning Q1 households spent more on shelter, food, and transport alone than their total reported income. The 2021 figure of 90.9% represents an improvement but remains extreme. For Q5, the same burden was 34.3%, 33.6%, and 28.0%. Q1 carried negative residual income after essentials in 2017 and 2019 (\$-217.7 and \$-1,412.5), while Q5 retained residual income of \$120,426, \$134,626, and \$162,227, respectively.

Shelter was the dominant burden component for Q1, reaching 53.6% of income in 2017 and 55.1% in 2019 before easing to 48.0% in 2021. These estimates carry bootstrap-verified 95% confidence intervals, confirming that the Q1 shelter burden was statistically distinct from all other quintiles in each year.

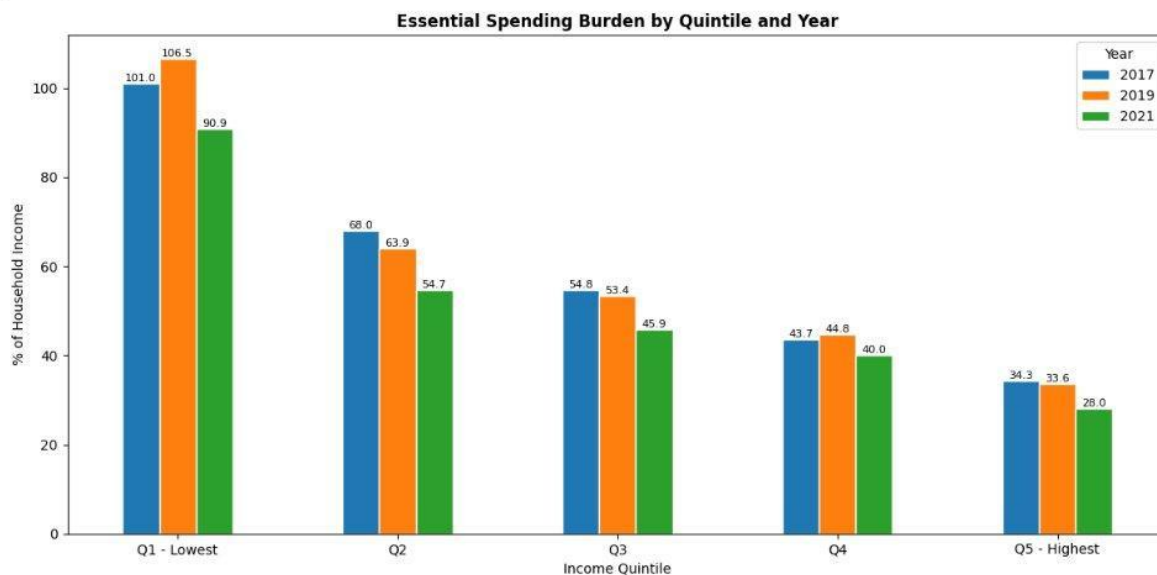


Figure 2. Essential spending burden by income quintile and year (% of household income)

Tenure Analysis

Renters and owners with mortgages faced similarly heavy housing pressure across all three years, while owners without mortgages remained substantially less constrained. Shelter burden for renters was 26.5% in 2017, 26.2% in 2019, and 24.0% in 2021 — high but showing gradual improvement. For owners with mortgages, it was 25.4%, 24.0%, and 24.2%, relatively stable throughout. For owners without mortgages, it was 12.5%, 13.2%, and 11.7% — less than half the burden of the other two groups.

The residual income gap by tenure is substantial. Owners without mortgages had residual income of \$60,209, \$60,334, and \$74,417 — significantly more than renters at \$22,025, \$25,071, and \$33,388. This tenure divide is one of the most persistent structural features of the dataset.

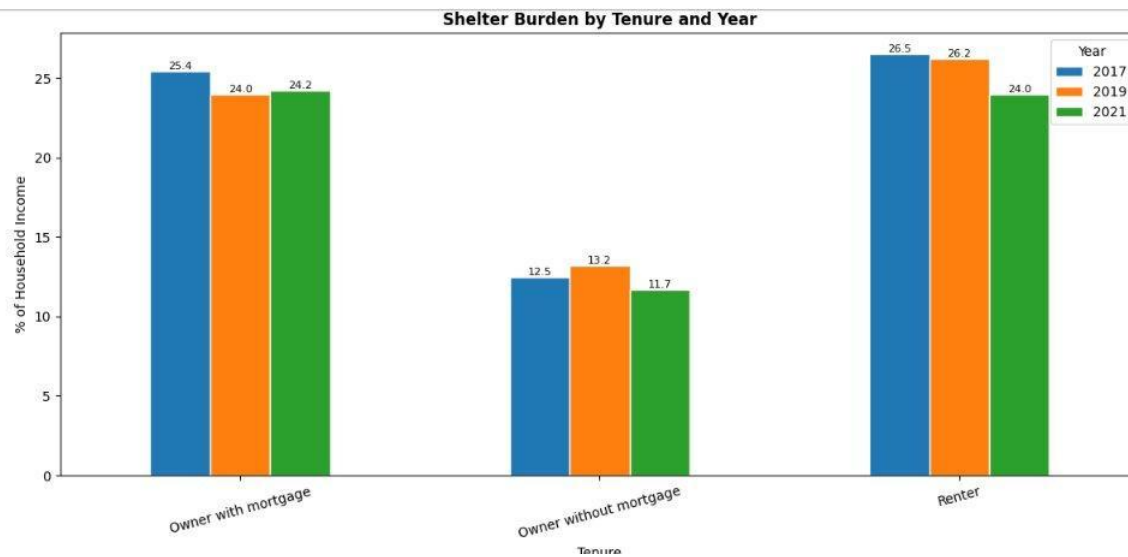


Figure 3. Shelter burden by tenure and year (% of household income)

Provincial Analysis

British Columbia had the highest shelter burden in all three years — 24.8%, 25.0%, and 23.3% — making it the most constrained major shelter market in Canada over the period. Ontario was consistently the second highest among major provinces at 23.4%, 22.3%, and 21.1%. Alberta had the highest average income in all three years (\$104,438, \$114,339, and \$121,256) but not the highest burden, because its income advantage partially offset housing costs.

Quebec had a consistently different profile — lower shelter burden (18.7%, 19.3%, 16.9%) and lower food burden than Ontario and British Columbia, likely due to lower housing costs and different household composition. The Atlantic provinces and smaller provinces often carried more relative pressure through food and transport, even when the shelter burden was lower than in British Columbia or Ontario. Saskatchewan saw the strongest increase in food burden across the period, while Ontario saw the largest easing.

4.2 Food & Consumer Sector Deep Dive

The Food & Consumer analysis covers how total household food spending changed and how the store-versus-restaurant split shifted across the pre-COVID and COVID-affected period. The key questions are channel shift, subcategory mix, income pressure, and provincial variation.

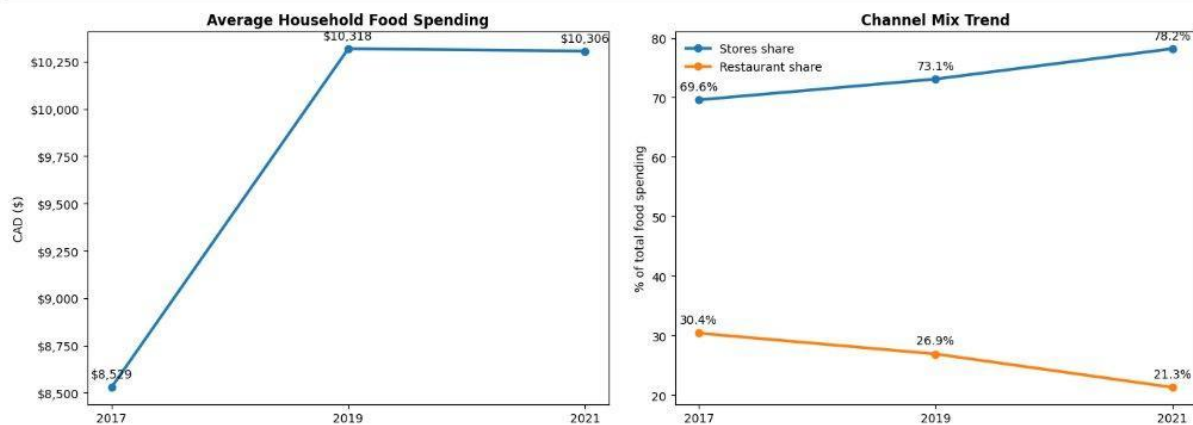


Figure 4a. Average household food spending and channel mix trend (2017–2021)

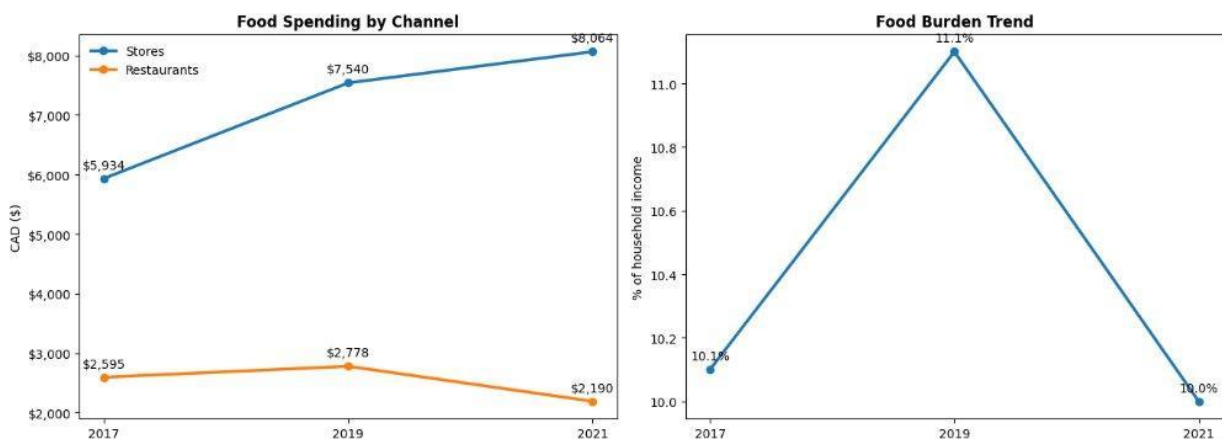


Figure 4b. Food spending by channel and food burden trend

National Food Trends

Total household food spending increased from \$8,528.7 in 2017 to \$10,317.9 in 2019 — a jump of 21.0% in two years — and then remained essentially unchanged at \$10,305.6 in 2021. The strongest structural shift was the movement from restaurant spending toward store-based food spending. Store share rose from 69.6% in 2017 to 73.1% in 2019 and then to 78.2% in 2021, while restaurant share fell from 30.4% to 26.9% and then to 21.3%. In dollar terms, food from stores grew from \$5,934 to \$8,064 while food from restaurants fell from \$2,595 to \$2,190 in 2021.

Food burden was 10.1% in 2017, rose to 11.1% in 2019, and eased to 10.0% in 2021. The national food burden easing in 2021 reflects both the income growth of that year and the drop in restaurant spending rather than a reduction in grocery spending pressure.

Food Subcategory Trends

Inside the store basket, the five most important subcategories in 2021 were non-alcoholic beverages and other food items (\$1,922.5), meat (\$1,516.3), dairy products and eggs (\$1,160.5), fruit preparations and nuts (\$1,030.2), and vegetables and preparations (\$966.9). Between 2017 and 2021, cereal grains

and products showed the strongest relative growth, rising from \$320.4 to \$463.0 (+44.5%). Dairy products and eggs rose from \$838.8 to \$1,160.5 (+38.3%), and meat rose from \$1,109.2 to \$1,516.3 (+36.7%). Bakery products showed the weakest relative growth, rising from \$562.5 to \$697.9 (+24.1%).

Year	2017	2019	2021
Subcategory			
Bakery products	562.5	687.1	697.9
Cereal grains & products	320.4	420.5	463.0
Dairy products & eggs	838.8	1050.9	1160.5
Fish & seafood	218.8	274.4	306.1
Fruit, preparations & nuts	731.0	930.3	1030.2
Meat	1109.2	1483.1	1516.3
Non-alcoholic beverages & other	1451.6	1718.2	1922.5
Vegetables & preparations	701.6	975.0	966.9

Table 3. Food subcategory average spending by year (CAD)

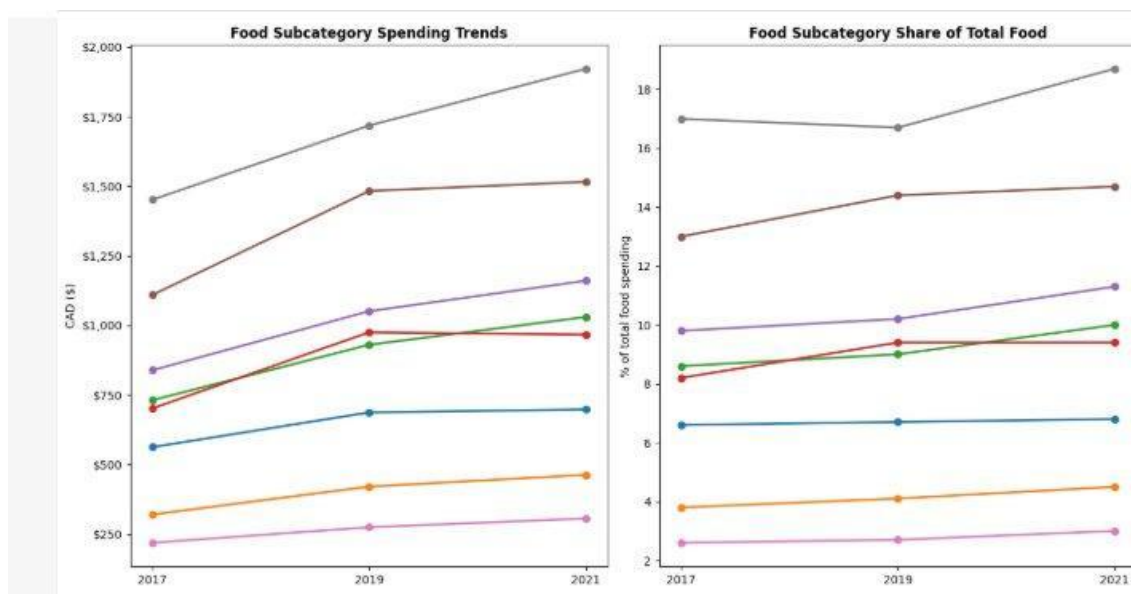


Figure 5. Food subcategory spending trends and share of total food

Food Spending by Income Quintile

Food burden by quintile shows the persistent nature of food pressure for lower-income households. Q1 faced food burdens of 22.5% in 2017, 25.7% in 2019, and 23.3% in 2021 — more than three times the Q5 burden of 7.0%, 7.7%, and 7.0%. Higher-income households also maintained a larger restaurant share throughout the period, though all quintiles saw restaurant share fall sharply in 2021 as COVID-era conditions suppressed out-of-home dining across the income spectrum.

In absolute dollar terms, Q5 food spending was \$12,875 in 2017 and \$15,744 in 2021, compared with \$4,797 and \$6,175 for Q1. Despite spending more in absolute terms, Q5 experienced this as a far

smaller share of income — the same food basket hits very differently depending on where a household sits in the distribution.

Year	Quintile	Avg Income	Total Food	Stores	Restaurants	Food Burden %	Restaurant Share %
2017	Q1 - Lowest	\$21,360.6	\$4,797.2	\$3,501.5	\$1,295.7	22.5%	27.0%
2017	Q2	\$44,332.7	\$6,558.0	\$5,022.2	\$1,535.8	14.8%	23.4%
2017	Q3	\$70,027.1	\$8,582.8	\$6,266.4	\$2,316.5	12.3%	27.0%
2017	Q4	\$104,193.4	\$9,818.6	\$6,738.3	\$3,080.3	9.4%	31.4%
2017	Q5 - Highest	\$183,291.2	\$12,875.4	\$8,135.6	\$4,739.8	7.0%	36.8%
2019	Q1 - Lowest	\$21,579.0	\$5,544.7	\$4,353.4	\$1,191.3	25.7%	21.5%
2019	Q2	\$48,239.0	\$7,931.8	\$5,940.7	\$1,991.2	16.4%	25.1%
2019	Q3	\$76,790.3	\$9,828.2	\$7,495.5	\$2,332.7	12.8%	23.7%
2019	Q4	\$114,757.0	\$12,663.8	\$9,056.2	\$3,607.6	11.0%	28.5%
2019	Q5 - Highest	\$202,891.2	\$15,610.1	\$10,844.4	\$4,765.7	7.7%	30.5%
2021	Q1 - Lowest	\$26,471.4	\$6,175.0	\$4,964.4	\$1,197.8	23.3%	19.4%
2021	Q2	\$53,177.8	\$7,590.5	\$6,096.2	\$1,481.0	14.3%	19.5%
2021	Q3	\$84,244.0	\$9,599.5	\$7,522.7	\$2,030.2	11.4%	21.1%
2021	Q4	\$125,766.4	\$12,409.4	\$9,677.2	\$2,667.7	9.9%	21.5%
2021	Q5 - Highest	\$225,360.4	\$15,744.4	\$12,050.0	\$3,572.5	7.0%	22.7%

Table 4. Food spending by income quintile and year

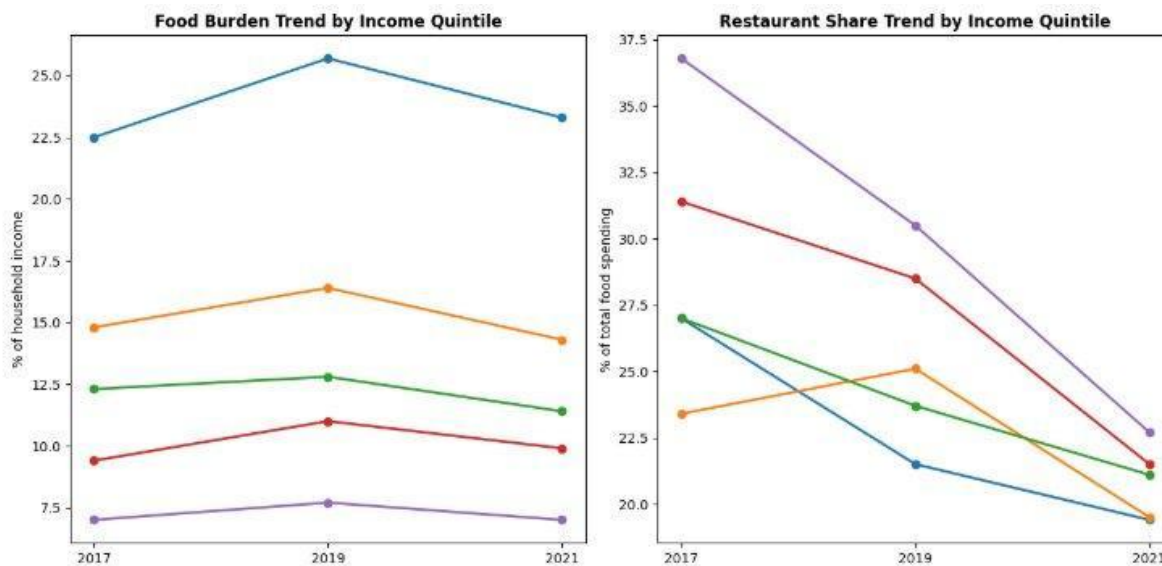


Figure 6. Food burden and restaurant share trend by income quintile

Provincial Food Patterns

Ontario had the highest restaurant share in 2017 at 33.9%, reflecting urban concentration and a stronger out-of-home food culture. British Columbia had the highest food burden among larger provinces in 2019 at 11.6%, partially driven by its high overall cost structure. Prince Edward Island and New Brunswick showed consistently higher food burdens than the national average across the period, reaching 12.3% and 12.0%, respectively, in 2021. Saskatchewan saw the strongest increase in

provincial food burden across the 2017–2021 period, rising to 12.0% in 2021, while Ontario saw the largest easing, dropping to 8.9%.

Year	Province	Avg Income	Total Food	Food Burden %	Restaurant Share %
2017	Alberta	\$104,438.3	\$9,092.1	8.7%	29.3%
2017	Atlantic Provinces	\$76,351.8	\$7,753.7	10.2%	25.6%
2017	British Columbia	\$84,781.8	\$9,245.5	10.9%	32.1%
2017	Manitoba	\$79,766.3	\$8,379.7	10.5%	30.2%
2017	Ontario	\$89,017.3	\$8,712.6	9.8%	33.9%
2017	Quebec	\$72,204.1	\$7,788.3	10.8%	25.6%
2017	Saskatchewan	\$87,532.2	\$9,143.3	10.4%	29.6%
2019	Alberta	\$114,339.2	\$11,322.2	9.9%	29.4%
2019	British Columbia	\$92,454.9	\$10,687.3	11.6%	29.1%
2019	Manitoba	\$88,473.6	\$9,956.8	11.3%	24.3%
2019	New Brunswick	\$78,576.0	\$9,483.6	12.1%	25.7%
2019	Newfoundland and Labrador	\$86,671.6	\$9,483.5	10.9%	21.4%
2019	Nova Scotia	\$81,824.9	\$9,077.5	11.1%	26.3%
2019	Ontario	\$96,543.0	\$10,418.3	10.8%	27.0%
2019	Prince Edward Island	\$74,840.7	\$9,231.5	12.3%	26.8%

Table 5. Provincial food spending and burden table

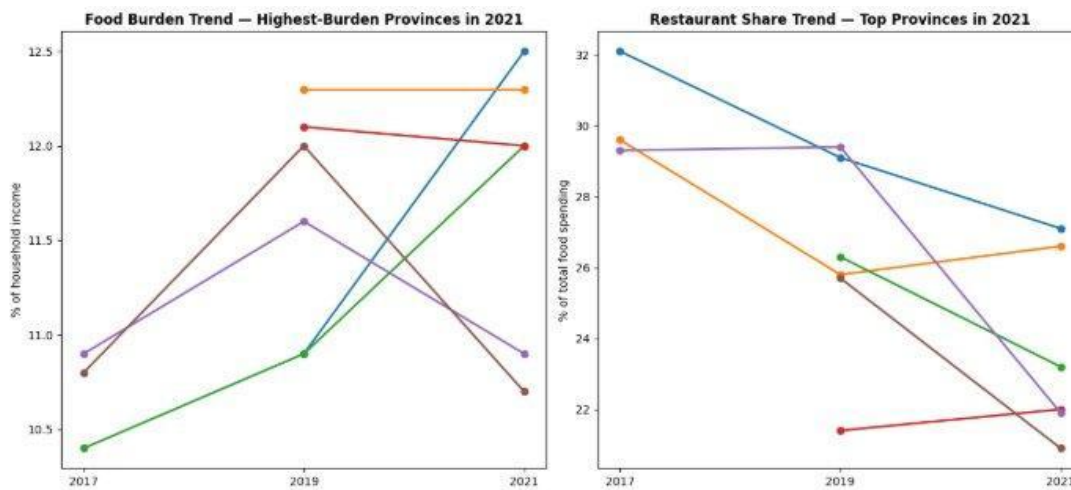


Figure 7. Food burden and restaurant share trend by province

4.3 Insurance Sector Deep Dive

The Insurance analysis focuses on visible household protection lines rather than a full insurer market model. Core insurance includes six lines: private health and dental (HC061), accident or disability (HC025), homeowners' property (SH015), mortgage-related insurance (SH019), secondary residence property (SH044), and vehicle insurance (TR085). Two adjacent context variables — personal insurance premiums and retirement/pension fund contributions (EP011) and financial services (ME039) — are tracked separately as indicators of broader long-term protection orientation.

One methodological consideration shapes how the 2017 data should be read in this sector. HC061 (private health and dental) and TR085 (vehicle insurance) were not available as separate line items in the 2017 SHS PUMF. As a result, the 2017 core insurance figures understate the true protection basket and are not fully comparable to 2019 and 2021. The 2017 figures are retained as a partial baseline, but 2019 and 2021 represent the more complete and analytically comparable pair.

Year	Private health & dental (HC061)	Accident / disability (HC025)	Homeowners property (SH015)	Mortgage-related insurance (SH019)	Secondary residence property (SH044)	Vehicle insurance (TR085)	Personal insurance + retirement (EP011)	Financial services (ME039)
2017	False	True	True	True	True	False	False	False
2019	True	True	True	True	True	True	True	True
2021	True	True	True	True	True	True	True	True

National trend overview

Table 6. Variable availability by year — insurance sector harmonization

National Insurance Trends

Average core insurance spending rose from \$1,002.6 in 2017 to \$3,097.3 in 2019 and \$3,171.3 in 2021. The 2017 figure is partial due to missing vehicle and health/dental lines. Insurance burden as a share of household income rose from 1.20% in 2017 to 3.30% in 2019 and eased slightly to 3.10% in 2021. Participation in any core insurance line increased from 70.3% to 89.9% and then 90.1% — near-universal by 2019 and essentially unchanged in 2021.

The adjacent EP011 variable (personal insurance and retirement) provides important context. Households spent an average of \$5,448.9 on EP011 in 2019 and \$5,914.8 in 2021 — substantially more than the core insurance total — indicating that the broader long-term protection orientation of Canadian households extends well beyond the visible lines tracked in this analysis.

Year	Avg Household Income	Avg Core Insurance Spend	Insurance Burden %	Any Core Insurance %	Avg Personal Insurance + Retirement	Avg Financial Services Spend	Private health & dental	Accident / disability	Homeowners property	Mortgage-related insurance	Secondary residence property	Vehicle insurance
2017	\$84,689.4	\$1,002.6	1.20%	70.3%	\$nan	\$nan	\$nan	\$141.6	\$712.5	\$90.2	\$58.3	\$nan
2019	\$92,883.2	\$3,097.3	3.30%	89.9%	\$5,448.9	\$798.2	\$743.7	\$141.4	\$817.7	\$115.1	\$53.8	\$1,225.7
2021	\$103,048.4	\$3,171.3	3.10%	90.1%	\$5,914.8	\$689.6	\$624.6	\$164.3	\$975.5	\$212.3	\$55.5	\$1,139.1

Table 7. National insurance overview table

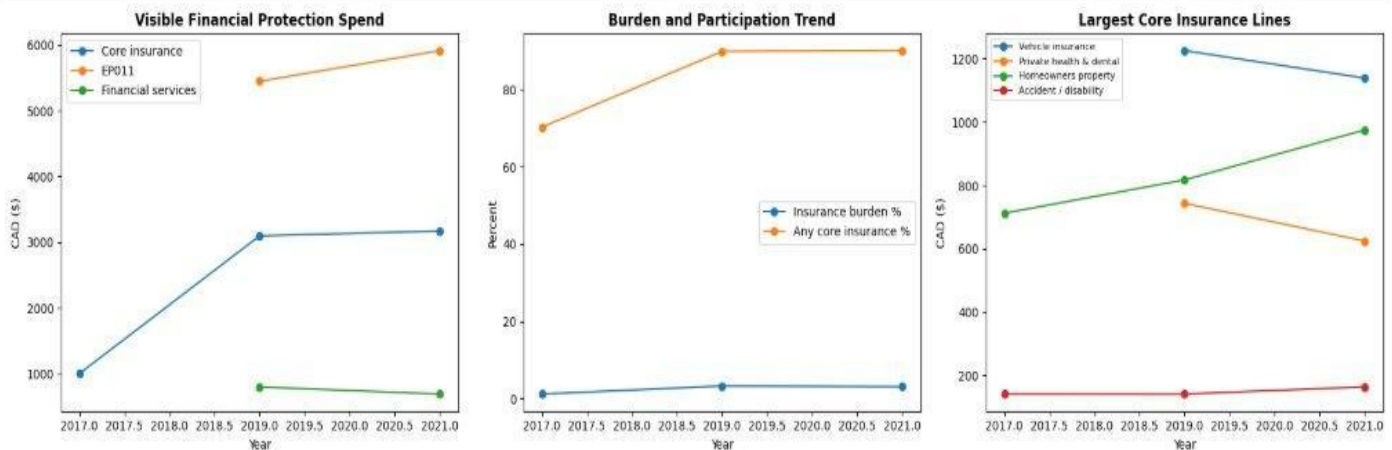


Figure 8. National insurance trends: protection spend, burden, and participation

Insurance Line Mix

The leading insurance line changed over the period. In 2017, homeowners' property was the top visible line at \$712.5, representing 71.1% of core insurance (noting that vehicle and health/dental were not separately available). In 2019 and 2021, vehicle insurance became the largest visible line at \$1,225.7 (39.6% of core) and \$1,139.1 (35.9% of core). Homeowners' property grew to \$817.7 in 2019 and \$975.5 in 2021. Mortgage-related insurance increased from \$90.2 in 2017 to \$212.3 in 2021 — a trend consistent with greater mortgage protection uptake over the period. Private health and dental participation fell slightly from 51.4% in 2019 to 47.7% in 2021, possibly due to COVID-era cancellations or premium pressure.

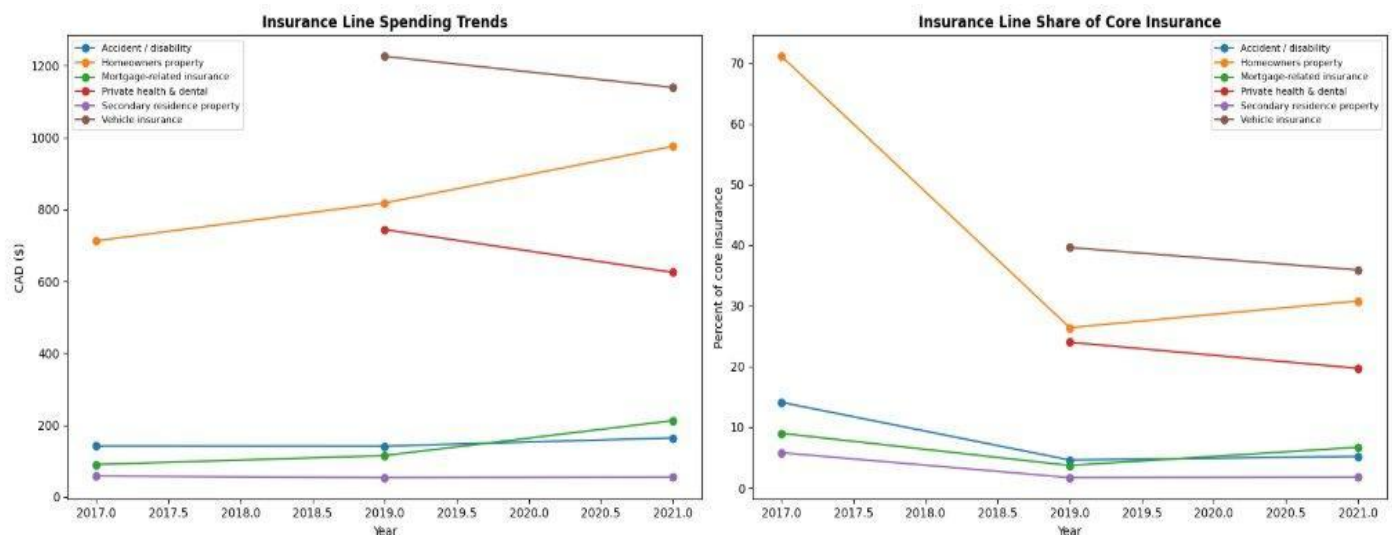


Figure 9. Insurance line spending trends and share of core insurance

Insurance by Income Quintile

Income is the strongest segmentation variable for insurance. Core insurance spending rose for all quintiles from 2017 to 2021, but the burden pattern diverged sharply. Q1 insurance burden rose from 1.70% in 2017 to 5.00% in 2019 and 5.20% in 2021. Q5 burden rose from 1.00% in 2017 to 2.60% in 2019 and then fell to 2.40% in 2021. This means that Q1 households faced more than twice the proportional insurance burden of Q5 households in 2019 and 2021.

Likewise, the absolute spending gap is also striking. Q5 core insurance rose from \$1,754.5 in 2017 to \$5,508.2 in 2021, compared with Q1 rising from \$362.0 to \$1,385.4. Higher-income households carry broader protection baskets — particularly in private health and dental, vehicle, and long-term protection via EP011 — while lower-income households face a higher burden from a narrower set of core lines.

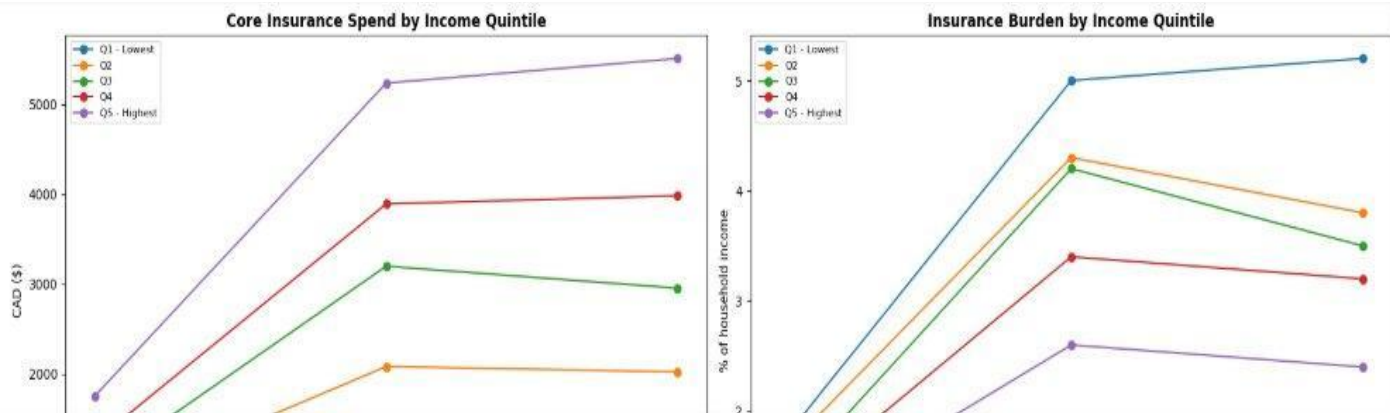


Figure 10. Core insurance spend and insurance burden by income quintile

Insurance by Tenure

Tenure is the second most important segmentation variable because property ownership, mortgage exposure, and vehicle access create fundamentally different protection baskets. Owners with mortgages carried the deepest protection baskets, with average core insurance of \$1,616.6 in 2017, \$4,412.3 in 2019, and \$4,436.7 in 2021, combining vehicle, homeowners' property, mortgage-related, and health/dental coverage. Owners without mortgages had similar insurance spend levels (\$1,293.2 in 2017, \$3,430.6 in 2019, \$3,585.0 in 2021) despite having no mortgage protection line.

Renters showed the sharpest relative increase, moving from \$90.4 in 2017 to \$1,269.7 in 2019 and \$1,159.8 in 2021. The 2017 renter figure is particularly partial given the missing HC061 and TR085 lines. By 2019, renters were carrying visible vehicle (\$758.3) and health/dental (\$442.1) coverage, though their insurance burden at 2.30% remained lower than that of owners because they lack the homeowners' property and mortgage lines that drive owner spending upward.

Year	Tenure	Avg Income	Core Insurance	Insurance Burden %	Any Core Insurance %	Vehicle insurance	Homeowners property	Private health & dental	Accident / disability	Mortgage-related insurance
2017	Owner with mortgage	\$108,153.8	\$1,616.6	1.50%	98.5%	\$nan	\$1,124.3	\$nan	\$214.9	\$243.6
2017	Owner without mortgage	\$94,176.1	\$1,293.2	1.40%	97.3%	\$nan	\$1,026.6	\$nan	\$127.9	\$0.0
2017	Renter	\$51,200.8	\$90.4	0.20%	16.7%	\$nan	\$0.0	\$nan	\$73.5	\$0.0
2019	Owner with mortgage	\$122,905.0	\$4,412.3	3.60%	99.3%	\$1,625.7	\$1,274.2	\$941.7	\$220.6	\$299.7
2019	Owner without mortgage	\$96,158.2	\$3,430.6	3.60%	98.6%	\$1,225.7	\$1,142.8	\$824.0	\$128.4	\$0.0
2019	Renter	\$54,949.6	\$1,269.7	2.30%	71.2%	\$758.3	\$0.0	\$442.1	\$60.3	\$0.0
2021	Owner with mortgage	\$131,732.9	\$4,436.7	3.40%	99.7%	\$1,411.0	\$1,399.6	\$743.1	\$256.2	\$580.6
2021	Owner without mortgage	\$106,558.2	\$3,585.0	3.40%	99.6%	\$1,229.7	\$1,382.6	\$740.3	\$138.8	\$0.0
2021	Renter	\$64,032.3	\$1,159.8	1.80%	67.6%	\$704.8	\$0.0	\$349.9	\$80.6	\$0.0

Table 8. Insurance spending and burden by tenure and year

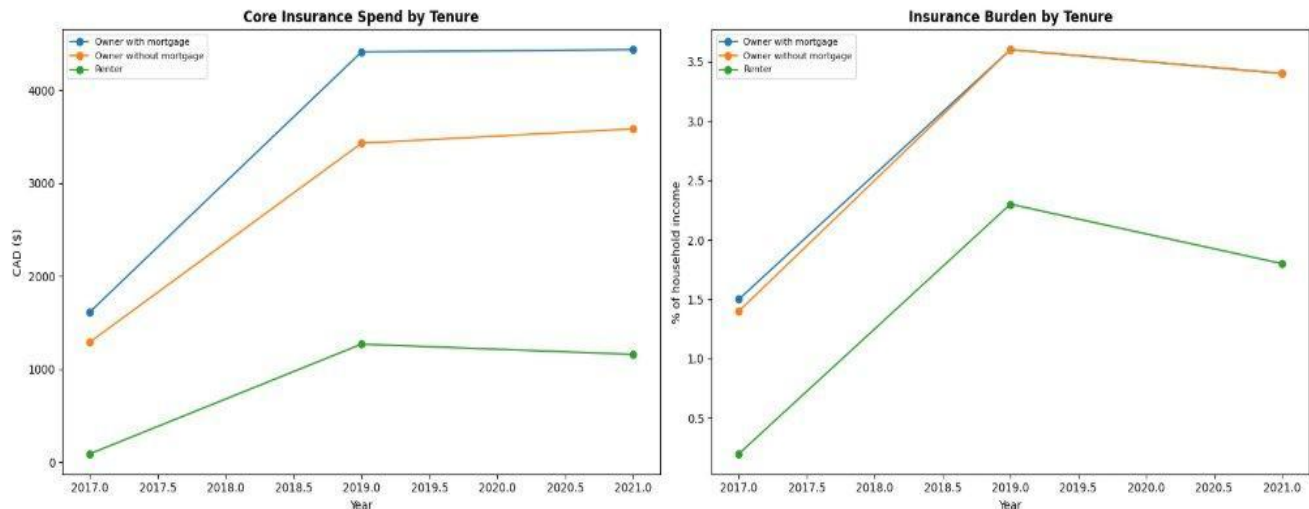


Figure 11. Core insurance spend and burden by tenure

Provincial Insurance Patterns

Provincial insurance markets are not one homogeneous national market — regulation, risk exposure, and income distribution all vary. In 2021, Alberta had the highest absolute core insurance spend at \$4,650.5 and showed the largest absolute increase from 2017 to 2021. New Brunswick had the highest insurance burden in 2021 at 4.40%, followed by Newfoundland and Labrador at 4.10% and Prince Edward Island at 3.90%. These Atlantic provinces combine lower average incomes with visible protection spending that drives the burden higher than in wealthier provinces.

Additionally, British Columbia had the lowest insurance burden in 2021 at 1.80%, which is notable given its position as the highest-burden shelter province. Quebec showed a relatively low insurance burden at 3.00%, consistent with its different vehicle insurance regulatory environment (public vehicle insurance). Manitoba and Saskatchewan showed the lowest core insurance spend in 2021, at \$2,114.2 and \$2,436.5, respectively, though their burden was moderate at 2.30% and 2.50%.

Year	Province	Avg Income	Core Insurance	Insurance Burden %	Vehicle insurance	Homeowners property	Private health & dental
2021	Alberta	\$121,256.2	\$4,650.5	3.80%	\$2,052.7	\$1,339.1	\$660.9
2021	Newfoundland and Labrador	\$92,023.7	\$3,748.0	4.10%	\$1,319.2	\$1,104.9	\$780.4
2021	New Brunswick	\$82,883.4	\$3,683.9	4.40%	\$1,267.0	\$1,026.4	\$898.1
2021	Ontario	\$110,189.2	\$3,613.2	3.30%	\$1,702.8	\$1,008.2	\$526.4
2021	Nova Scotia	\$88,338.4	\$3,368.3	3.80%	\$1,248.5	\$993.6	\$705.4
2021	Prince Edward Island	\$84,267.5	\$3,255.2	3.90%	\$1,241.0	\$670.4	\$829.5
2021	Quebec	\$90,521.2	\$2,717.0	3.00%	\$774.8	\$746.9	\$743.8
2021	Saskatchewan	\$97,541.4	\$2,436.5	2.50%	\$0.0	\$1,232.0	\$692.4
2021	Manitoba	\$91,981.2	\$2,114.2	2.30%	\$0.0	\$948.3	\$669.1
2021	British Columbia	\$103,654.1	\$1,864.7	1.80%	\$0.0	\$949.2	\$544.8

Table 9. Provincial insurance overview table (2021)

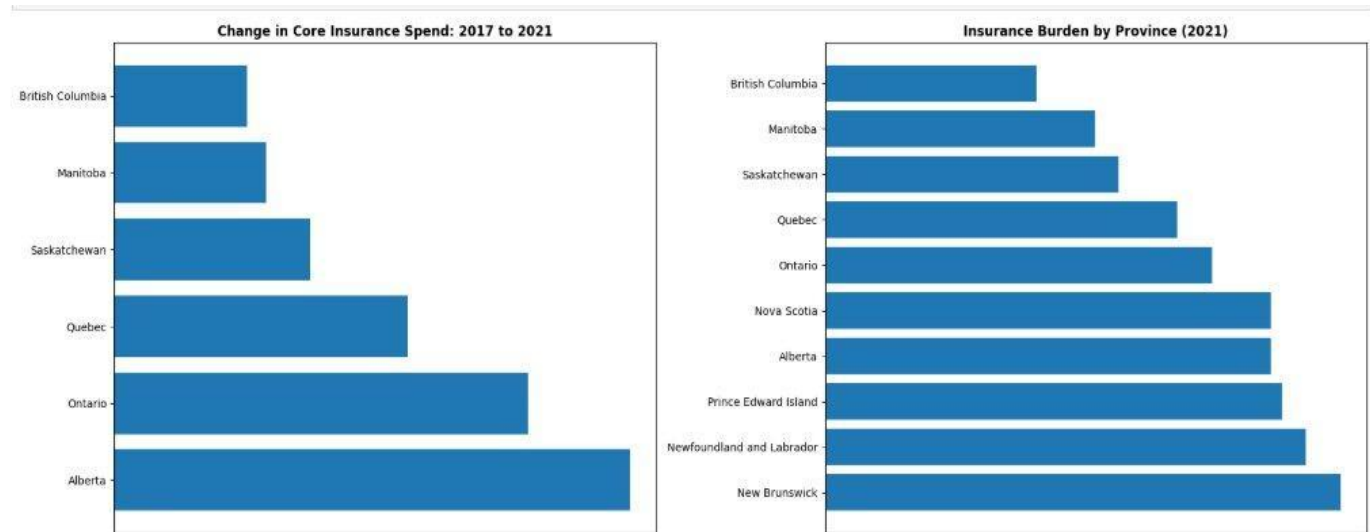


Figure 12. Change in core insurance spend (2017–2021) and insurance burden by province

Insurance Protection Scorecard

Year	Avg Core Insurance Spend	Insurance Burden %	Participation %	Top Insurance Line	Top Line Avg Spend	Q1 Burden %	Q5 Burden %	Owner w/ Mortgage Core Insurance	Renter Core Insurance
2017	\$1,002.6	1.20%	70.3%	Homeowners property	\$712.5	1.70%	1.00%	\$1,616.6	\$90.4
2019	\$3,097.3	3.30%	89.9%	Vehicle insurance	\$1,225.7	5.00%	2.60%	\$4,412.3	\$1,269.7
2021	\$3,171.3	3.10%	90.1%	Vehicle insurance	\$1,139.1	5.20%	2.40%	\$4,436.7	\$1,159.8

Table 10. Insurance protection scorecard: national summary by year

4.4 2023 Official Bridge: Post-2021 Structural Update

The 2023 official bridge extends the report beyond the COVID-affected 2021 reference year using published Statistics Canada aggregate results (table 11-10-0222-01). While it does not offer the same household-level structure as the SHS PUMF comparative core, it provides a meaningful post-2021 update on national expenditure levels, food channel composition, provincial spending patterns, and shelter intensity. The comparison is strongest for national expenditure levels, food, shelter, and transport structure, food channel split, and provincial ranking patterns. It does not reproduce quintile, tenure, or bootstrap confidence interval analysis.

Methodological Note

This bridge compares 2021 PUMF-based national results (already validated in the project) against 2023 official aggregate results from Statistics Canada. This is a valid analytical bridge, but it is not a perfect like-for-like microdata comparison. The 2021 figures use household income as the denominator for burden calculations; the 2023 figures use current consumption. Provincial comparisons should therefore be read as ranking and structural pattern comparisons rather than direct burden-point comparisons.

National Bridge: 2021 vs 2023

At the national level, average total household expenditure rose from \$90,185 in 2021 to \$108,225 in 2023, an increase of \$18,039 or 20.0%. Average food spending increased from \$10,306 to \$12,046 (+\$1,740, +16.9%), and average shelter spending rose from \$20,457 to \$24,671 (+\$4,214, +20.6%). Transport expenditure also rebounded sharply, from \$10,289 to \$12,090 (+\$1,801, +17.5%), reinforcing the interpretation that 2021 transport spending was still compressed by COVID-era conditions.

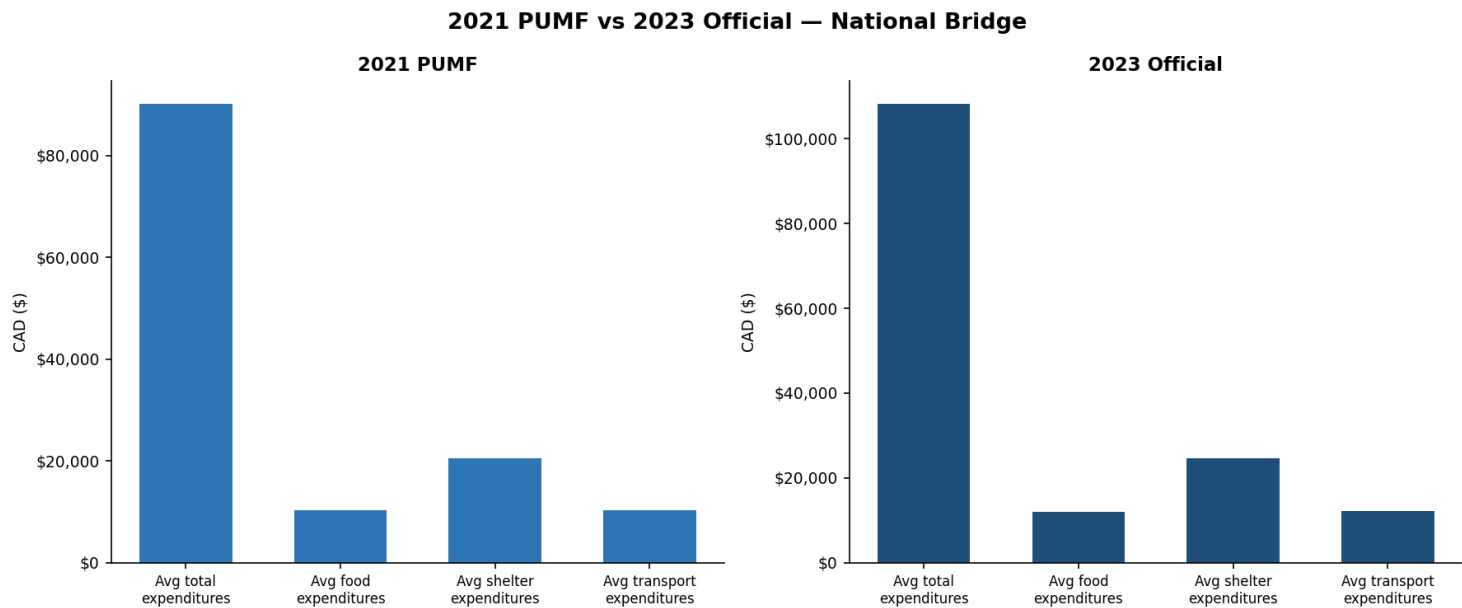


Figure 13. 2021 PUMF vs 2023 Official — National Bridge (nominal CAD)

Metric	2021 PUMF	2023 Official	Absolute Change	Pct Change
Avg total expenditure	\$90,185	\$108,225	+\$18,039	+20.0%
Avg food expenditure	\$10,306	\$12,046	+\$1,740	+16.9%
Food from stores	\$8,064	\$8,659	+\$595	+7.4%
Food from restaurants	\$2,190	\$3,351	+\$1,160	+53.0%
Avg shelter expenditure	\$20,457	\$24,671	+\$4,214	+20.6%
Avg transport expenditure	\$10,289	\$12,090	+\$1,801	+17.5%
Stores share %	78.2%	71.9%	-6.3pp	-8.1%
Restaurants share %	21.3%	27.8%	+6.5pp	+30.6%

Table 11. 2021 PUMF vs 2023 Official — National Bridge (nominal CAD)

Key Findings: 2021 to 2023

Seven findings stand out from the national bridge. First, total household expenditure increased strongly (+20.0%), reflecting a combination of higher nominal spending and general price-level increases across the period. Second, shelter continued to rise and remained the largest structural spending category. Third, food increased overall, but the strongest growth came from restaurants (+53.0%) rather than stores (+7.4%). Fourth, the store-heavy food pattern observed in 2021 softened significantly in 2023 as restaurant spending rebounded. Fifth, transport also rebounded strongly (+17.5%), supporting the interpretation that 2021 transport spending was still compressed by COVID-era mobility restrictions. Sixth, at the provincial level, Ontario and British Columbia remained among the most shelter-intensive markets. Seventh, provincial comparisons should be read as ranking and pattern comparisons, not as direct burden-point changes, because the 2021 and 2023 denominators differ.

Food Channel Shift: 2021 vs 2023

The food channel shift is the most structurally significant change between 2021 and 2023. Store share fell from 78.2% to 71.9% (-6.3 percentage points) while restaurant share rose from 21.3% to 27.8% (+6.5 percentage points). In dollar terms, food from restaurants rose from \$2,190 to \$3,351, a 53.0% increase, while food from stores rose only modestly from \$8,064 to \$8,659 (+7.4%). This confirms that the 2021 food structure reflected pandemic-era suppression of out-of-home consumption, not a permanent structural shift toward home cooking.

Food Channels — 2021 vs 2023

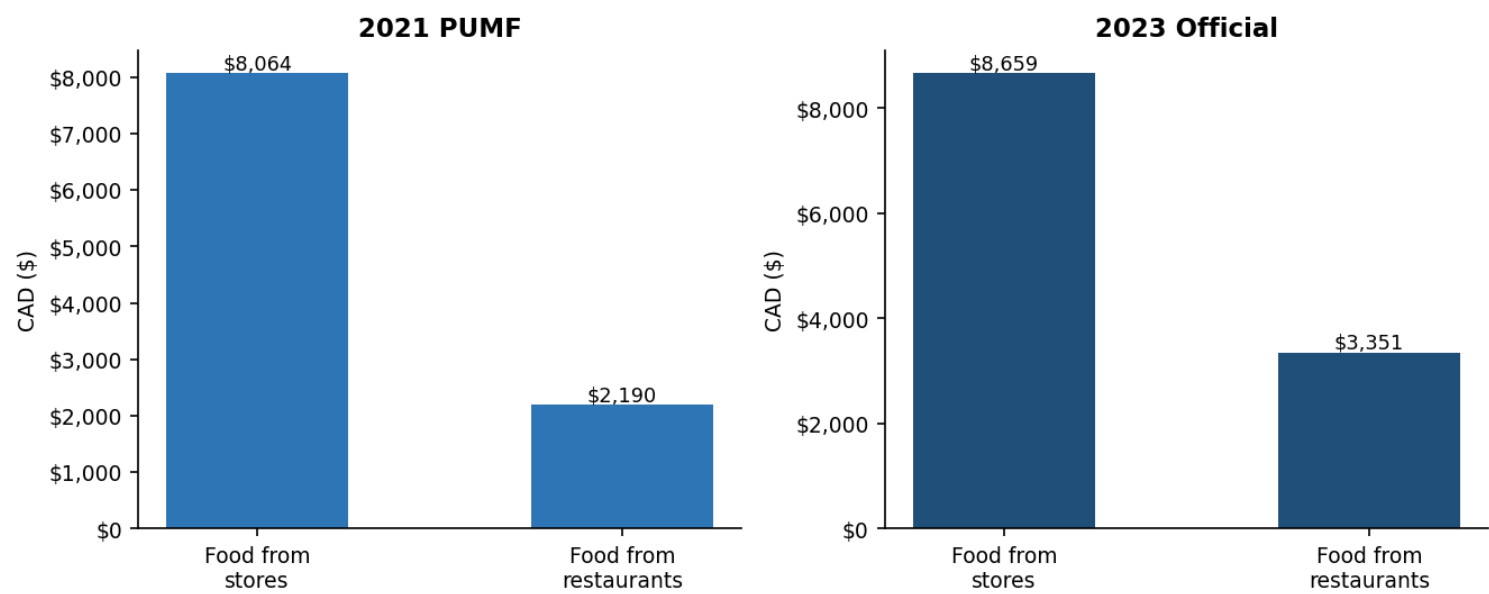


Figure 14. Food channel split — 2021 vs 2023

Food Subcategory Mix — 2023

Inside the 2023 store basket, the dominant subcategory was non-alcoholic beverages and other food products at \$2,153 (17.9% of total food spending). Meat ranked second at \$1,544 (12.8%), followed by dairy products and eggs at \$1,203 (10.0%), fruit and nut preparations at \$1,073 (8.9%), and vegetables and preparations at \$1,031 (8.6%). Bakery products accounted for \$861 (7.1%), cereal grains and cereals for \$523 (4.3%), and fish and seafood for \$270 (2.2%). The overall mix remains protein- and staple-heavy, consistent with the subcategory pattern observed in 2021.

Subcategory	Avg Spend (CAD)	Share of Total Food (%)
Non-alcoholic beverages and other food products	\$2,153	17.9%
Meat	\$1,544	12.8%
Dairy products and eggs	\$1,203	10.0%
Fruit, fruit preparations and nuts	\$1,073	8.9%
Vegetables and vegetable preparations	\$1,031	8.6%
Bakery products	\$861	7.1%
Cereal grains and cereal products	\$523	4.3%
Fish and seafood	\$270	2.2%

Table 12. Food subcategory summary — Official 2023

Provincial Patterns — 2023

Shelter remained the largest structural spending category in 2023 at all provincial levels. Ontario had the highest shelter share of current consumption at 35.8%, followed closely by British Columbia at 34.8% and Alberta at 30.4%. This ranking is consistent with the 2017–2021 PUMF core, where British Columbia and Ontario led on shelter burden throughout the period. Saskatchewan (28.4%), Nova

Scotia (27.8%), and Prince Edward Island (27.8%) occupied the middle tier, while Newfoundland and Labrador had the lowest shelter share at 23.5% and New Brunswick at 25.5%. On food, Alberta had the highest absolute food spending at \$14,526, followed by Newfoundland and Labrador at \$13,414 and Saskatchewan at \$11,736. Ontario had one of the lower food shares at 14.4% of current consumption, while Newfoundland and Labrador (19.9%) and New Brunswick (17.4%) carried proportionally heavier food loads. For transport, Alberta and Saskatchewan led in both absolute spending (\$14,539 and \$11,525) and share of consumption (16.5% and 17.8%). Ontario had the highest restaurant share of food spending in 2023 at 31.5%, consistent with its urban out-of-home food culture. British Columbia and Prince Edward Island also had high restaurant shares at approximately 30%. At the other end, Newfoundland and Labrador had the highest store share at approximately 80%, followed by Quebec at approximately 78%. This provincial food channel pattern is broadly consistent with the ranking observed in the 2021 PUMF core. Because the 2023 provincial indicators use current consumption as the denominator rather than household income (as used in the PUMF core), shelter shares in 2023 appear higher in absolute percentage terms than the income-based burden estimates from 2017–2021. These results should be read as structural pattern and ranking comparisons, not as direct burden-point continuations of the PUMF series.

Canadian Household Spending by Province — Official 2023

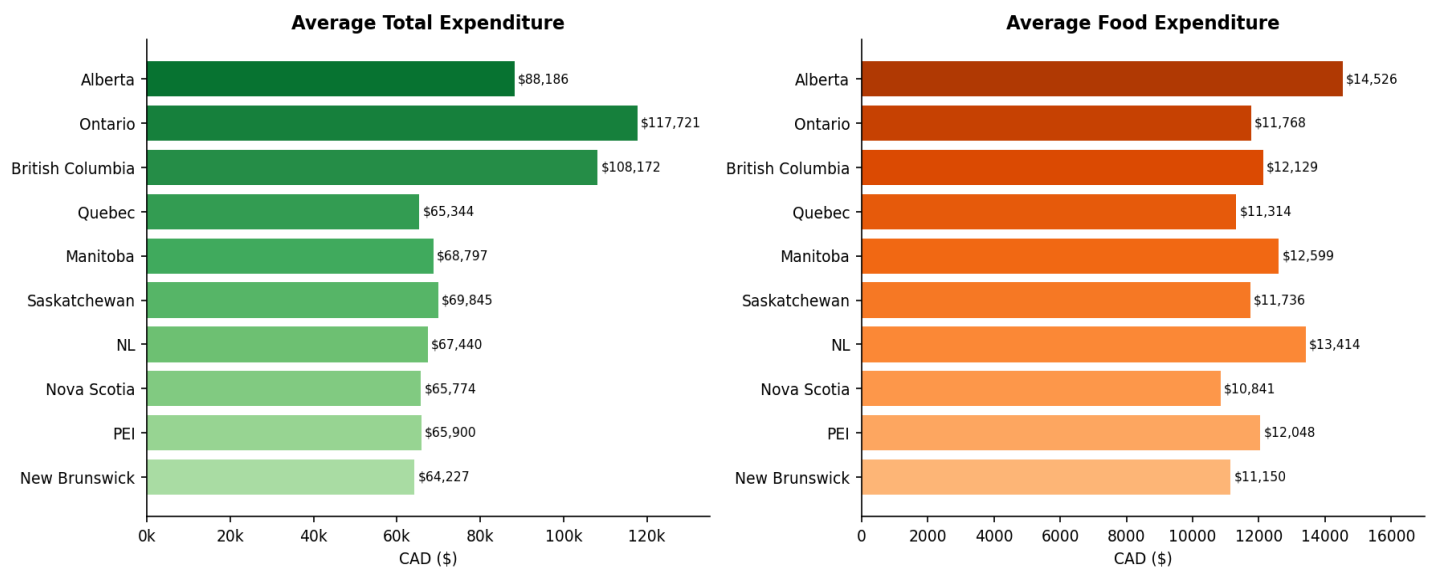


Figure 12. Average total and food expenditure by province — Official 2023

Canadian Household Spending by Province — Official 2023

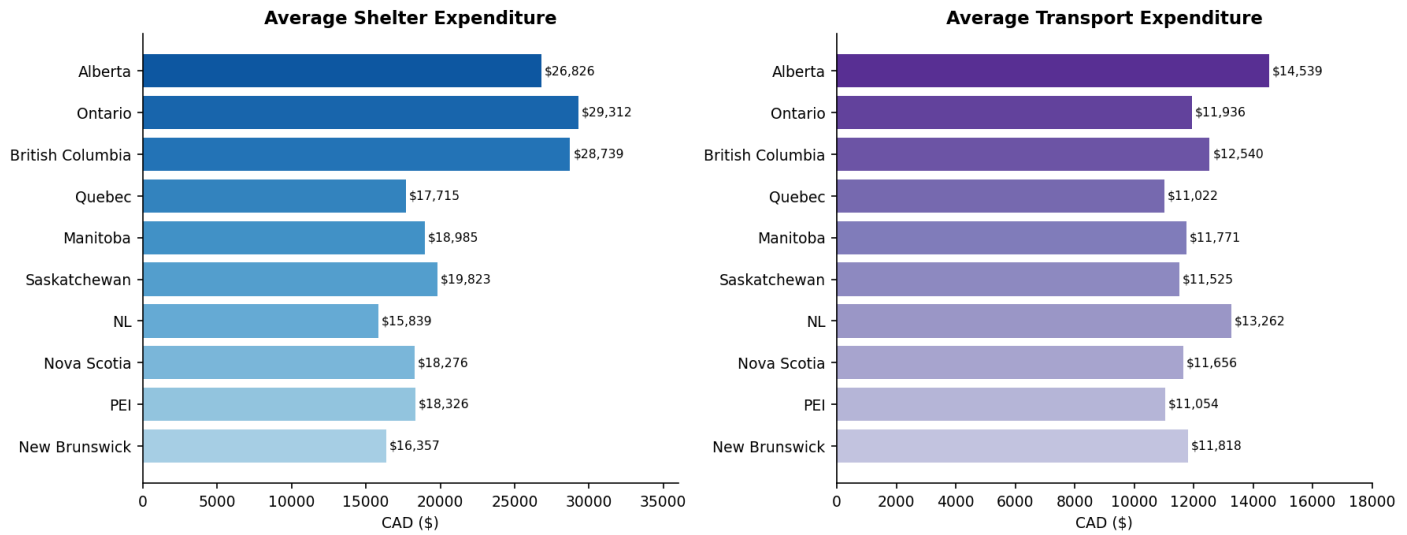


Figure 13. Average shelter and transport expenditure by province — Official 2023

Province	Avg Total Exp	Avg Food	Avg Shelter	Avg Transport	Shelter % Cons.	Food % Cons.	Transport % Cons.
Ontario	\$117,721	\$11,768	\$29,312	\$11,936	35.8%	14.4%	14.6%
British Columbia	\$108,172	\$12,129	\$28,739	\$12,540	34.8%	14.7%	15.2%
Alberta	\$88,186	\$14,526	\$26,826	\$14,539	30.4%	16.5%	16.5%
Saskatchewan	\$69,845	\$11,736	\$19,823	\$11,525	28.4%	18.2%	17.8%
Nova Scotia	\$65,774	\$10,841	\$18,276	\$11,656	27.8%	16.5%	17.7%
Prince Edward Island	\$65,900	\$12,048	\$18,326	\$11,054	27.8%	18.3%	16.8%
Manitoba	\$68,797	\$12,599	\$18,985	\$11,771	27.6%	18.3%	17.1%
Quebec	\$65,344	\$11,314	\$17,715	\$11,022	27.1%	17.3%	16.9%
New Brunswick	\$64,227	\$11,150	\$16,357	\$11,818	25.5%	17.4%	18.4%
Newfoundland and Labrador	\$67,440	\$13,414	\$15,839	\$13,262	23.5%	19.9%	19.7%

Table 13. Provincial spending summary — Official 2023 (nominal CAD)

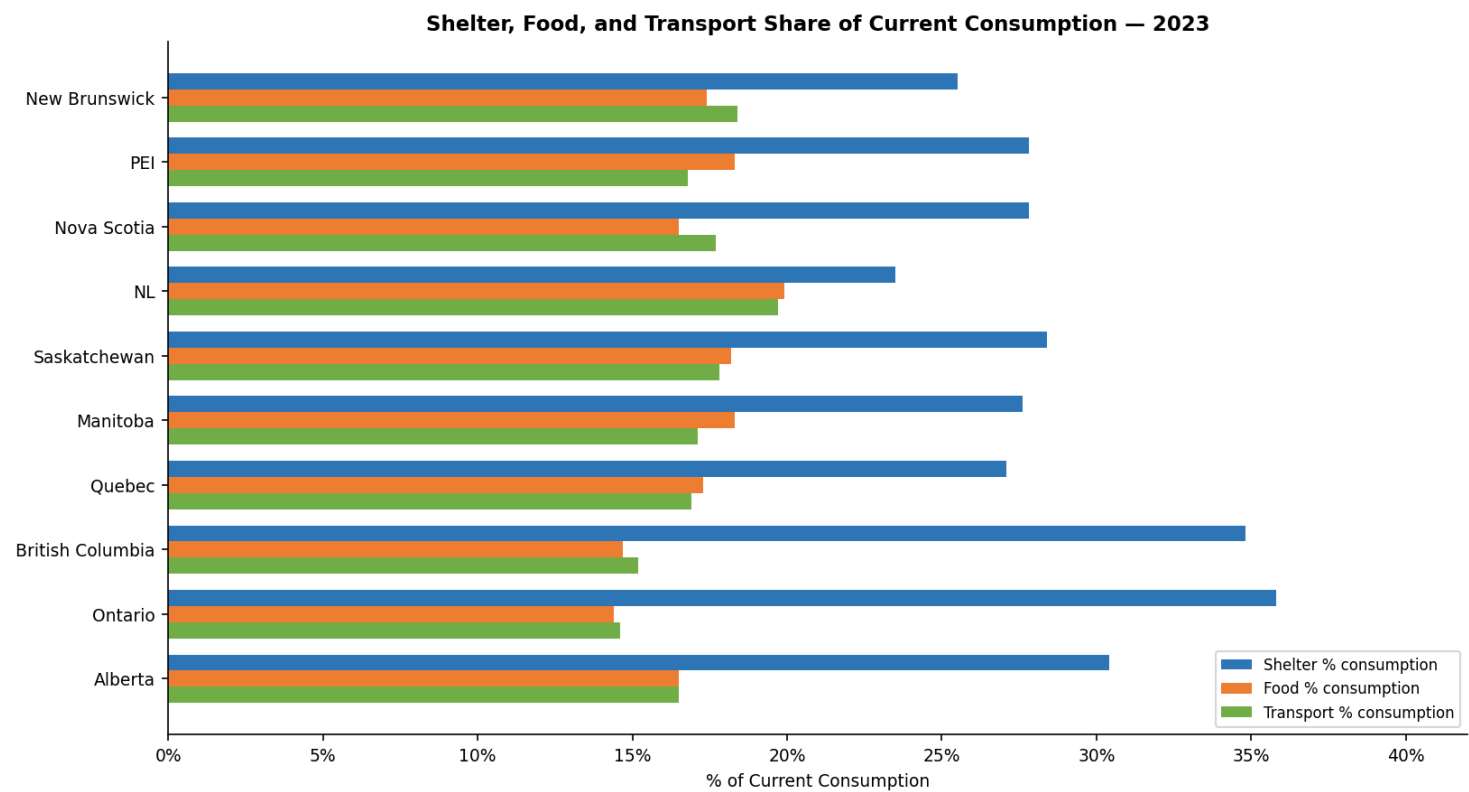


Figure 17. Shelter, food, and transport share of current consumption — 2023

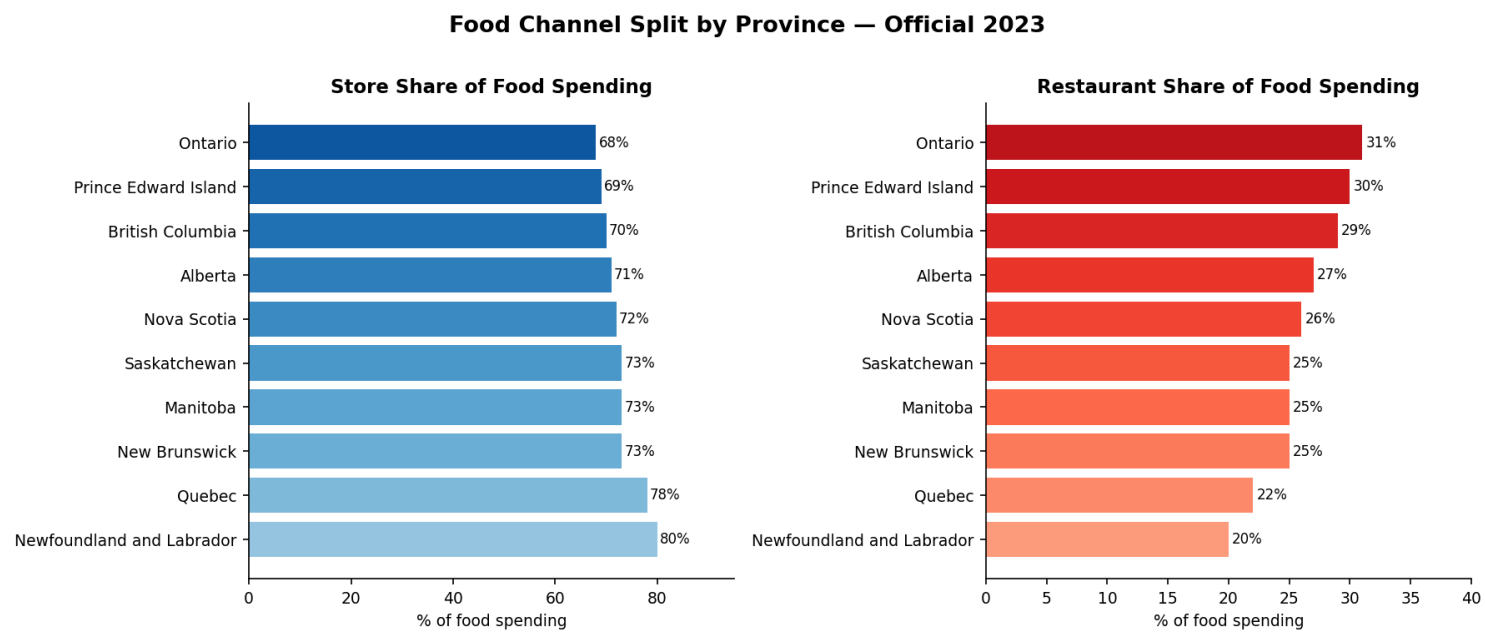


Figure 18. Food channel split by province — Official 2023

Shelter Intensity Ranking — 2023

Rank	Province	Avg Current Consumption	Avg Shelter	Shelter % Consumption
1	Ontario	\$81,975	\$29,312	35.8%
2	British Columbia	\$82,657	\$28,739	34.8%
3	Alberta	\$88,186	\$26,826	30.4%
4	Saskatchewan	\$69,845	\$19,823	28.4%
5	Nova Scotia	\$65,774	\$18,276	27.8%
6	Prince Edward Island	\$65,900	\$18,326	27.8%
7	Manitoba	\$68,797	\$18,985	27.6%
8	Quebec	\$65,344	\$17,715	27.1%
9	New Brunswick	\$64,227	\$16,357	25.5%
10	Newfoundland and Labrador	\$67,440	\$15,839	23.5%

Table 14. Provincial shelter share of current consumption, ranked — 2023

Interpretation Notes

First, several of the strongest 2021 patterns were at least partly shaped by COVID-era conditions rather than representing a stable long-run endpoint. This is clearest in food channels and transportation. The restaurant share collapse to 21.3% in 2021 and the transport drop to \$10,289 both reversed significantly by 2023, confirming that 2021 represented a distorted baseline rather than a structural shift.

Second, shelter remained the most structurally dominant category after 2021. Even though the 2023 provincial measure uses current consumption rather than income, the same housing-intensive markets — Ontario and British Columbia — remain at the top of the provincial ranking. This consistency across two different methodological frameworks strengthens the report's central conclusion about shelter as the primary driver of household financial pressure in Canada.

Third, the 2023 extension is analytically valuable even without quintile and tenure tables. It shows what happened to the national structure of household spending after the 2021 reference year: spending rose across all major categories, restaurant activity normalized, and transport rebounded. These post-COVID structural shifts provide important context for interpreting the 2017–2021 PUMF core findings.

5. Discussion

The findings hold up at every level of analysis and point to the same conclusion: national average improvements in Canadian household spending between 2017 and 2021 obscure persistent structural inequality by income, tenure, and geography.

Shelter is the heaviest burden in Canadian household spending. It is large in absolute terms, stable or growing for lower-income households, and strongly amplified by tenure status and province. British Columbia was the persistently highest-burden shelter market, and the Q1 shelter burden — statistically verified through bootstrap confidence intervals — stayed above 48% in all three years.

Food spending tells a different story. The shift from restaurants to stores was the dominant structural change, and it was already underway before 2021. Inside the store basket, spending moved toward

protein, dairy, and beverages — consistent with both inflationary pressure on staples and more home cooking. For Q1 households, food stayed a 22–26% burden throughout, which limited how much they could benefit from channel efficiency gains.

On the other hand, insurance is not an immediate necessity the way shelter or food is, but it is a useful lens on protection, tenure, and income segmentation. The expansion of visible household insurance from 2017 to 2019 was sharp, and the data gap in 2017 (missing HC061 and TR085) means the true trajectory may be smoother than it appears. When Q1 households face a 5.2% insurance burden in 2021 on top of an essential burden of 90.9%, the pressure compounds in ways the national average cannot show.

Taken together, these results argue that household stress in Canada cannot be read from national averages. The research question asked why spending patterns vary, and the answer is structural: income-driven differences in affordability, tenure-driven differences in the size and composition of essential and protection baskets, and provincial differences in housing markets, insurance regulation, and cost structures.

The 2023 official bridge strengthens the interpretation of 2021 as a transitional year rather than a stable endpoint. The rebound in restaurant spending and transport expenditure between 2021 and 2023 confirms that some of the 2021 easing was shaped by COVID-era behavioural conditions rather than by a lasting structural reduction in affordability pressure. At the same time, shelter remained the dominant structural category in 2023, reinforcing the report's central conclusion that housing continues to define the geography of household financial stress in Canada.

6. Conclusion and Recommendations

Canadian household spending between 2017 and 2021 cannot be understood through averages alone. Lower-income households faced extreme essential burdens every year of the period. British Columbia remained the most consistently burdened shelter market. Food spending stayed high but shifted decisively toward stores, especially by 2021. Insurance spending expanded sharply after 2017 and remained elevated, with strong segmentation by income, tenure, and province. The 2023 official bridge supports this interpretation by showing that post-2021 household spending continued to rise in nominal terms, that shelter remained the largest structural category, and that food and transport patterns moved further away from the COVID-affected structure observed in 2021.

Four recommendations follow from the analysis:

- Keep shelter at the centre of burden analysis. Any policy or market interpretation of Canadian household affordability must foreground shelter, particularly for Q1 and renters, where the burden exceeds 50% of income.
- Use quintiles explicitly in sector interpretation. Sector-level averages (food burden of 10%, insurance burden of 3%) obscure the reality that Q1 households face food burdens above 23% and combined essential burdens above 90%.
- Treat 2021 as a high-value but still COVID-affected reference year. The transport drop, the restaurant share collapse, and the insurance participation jump in 2021 all contain COVID-era distortions that should be separated from structural trends.
- Expand provincial insurance analysis. The variation in provincial insurance burden — from 1.80% in British Columbia to 4.40% in New Brunswick — suggests that provincial-level regulation, risk exposure, and income distribution interact in ways that merit deeper investigation.

Canadian household spending between 2017 and 2021 improved on average — but that average obscures how unevenly those improvements landed. Income growth, falling transport costs, and shifting food channels produced real gains for middle and upper-income households. For the lowest-income quintile, for renters in high-cost markets, and for households in provinces with elevated shelter and insurance burdens, the period looked very different. Understanding Canadian household spending means moving past the national average and into the structural inequality the data consistently reveals.

7. Limitations

The SHS PUMF is anonymized and therefore limits granular household-level inference. The 2017 file differs from later years in two important ways: the project uses the Diary file, and the Atlantic provinces are grouped under a single geographic code. Some sector variables in 2017 are not available as separate line items — most importantly, private health and dental (HC061) and vehicle insurance (TR085) in the insurance analysis — which creates an apparent discontinuity between 2017 and 2019/2021 that is methodological rather than behavioural.

The insurance analysis covers visible household protection lines only. It is not a full insurer market model and does not capture life insurance, commercial coverage, or group coverage not reflected in the SHS hierarchy. Finally, 2021 still reflects COVID-era conditions, especially in mobility (suppressed transport and restaurant spending) and home-centred behaviour (elevated grocery and homeowners' property insurance), which limits the degree to which 2021 results can be treated as a stable post-COVID equilibrium.

A final limitation concerns the 2023 extension. Unlike the 2017, 2019, and 2021 comparative core, the 2023 analysis is based on official aggregate tables rather than SHS PUMF microdata. This means the report cannot reproduce fully symmetric 2023 quintile, tenure, or bootstrap-based burden analysis. The 2023 material should therefore be interpreted as an official contextual bridge that extends the report's narrative beyond 2021, rather than as a fourth microdata-equivalent year in the comparative core.

8. Intern Reflection

What skills did you develop during this project?

During this project, I developed hands-on experience working with Statistics Canada's SHS PUMF data in SAS format (sas7bdat), including understanding the variable hierarchy, spending categories, and survey weights. I improved my Python environment management by creating a dedicated Jupyter kernel (shs2021) to ensure reproducibility across notebooks. I also strengthened my statistical analysis skills, including bootstrap confidence interval estimation, quintile segmentation, and burden ratio calculations applied to real public microdata.

What was the most challenging part of the research?

The most challenging aspect was harmonizing the 2017 SHS PUMF with the 2019 and 2021 files, as the 2017 Diary file uses different variable structures — key insurance lines like vehicle insurance (TR085) and private health and dental (HC061) were not available as separate items, and Atlantic provinces were grouped under a single geographic code. Identifying these structural differences and deciding how to handle them transparently in the analysis required careful methodological judgment.

What would you do differently next time?

I would establish the cross-year variable harmonization framework at the very beginning of the project, before writing any analysis code, to avoid having to revisit and adjust notebooks later. I would also document the data limitations for each year in a shared reference file from the start, so that every sector notebook could draw from a single source of truth rather than rediscovering the same constraints independently.

How does this project connect to your academic or career goals?

This project directly supports my goal of building Canadian work experience in data analysis. Working with Statistics Canada's public microdata gave me exposure to real Canadian datasets and the analytical frameworks used to interpret the Canadian market. Understanding how household spending varies across provinces, income groups, and tenure status is exactly the kind of market knowledge that is relevant for data analyst roles in Canada's public, nonprofit, and private sectors.

Written Reflection

This research experience was my second time working end-to-end with a large Canadian public microdata file, from raw SAS data cleaning through to a structured comparative report. I learned that real-world data analysis is rarely linear — the 2017 file required different handling than 2019 and 2021, and those decisions shaped every finding that followed. Beyond the technical skills, I developed a deeper understanding of how income, housing tenure, and geography interact to create very different financial realities for Canadian households. This project gave me both the technical foundation and the Canadian market context I need to grow as a data analyst in this country.

Appendix: Key Comparative Indicators

A1. National Comparative Summary

Year	Avg Income	Avg Total Exp	Avg Shelter	Avg Food	Avg Transport	Essential Burden	Residual Income
2017	\$84,689	\$83,801	\$18,207	\$8,529	\$12,972	46.9%	\$44,981
2019	\$92,883	\$91,051	\$19,716	\$10,318	\$12,874	46.2%	\$49,975
2021	\$103,048	\$90,185	\$20,457	\$10,306	\$10,289	39.8%	\$61,997

Table 15. National Comparative Summary

A2. Essential Burden by Income Quintile

Year	Quintile	Avg Income	Avg Shelter	Avg Food	Avg Transport	Essential Burden	Residual Income
2017	Q1 - Lowest	\$21,361	\$11,454	\$4,797	\$5,328	101.0%	-\$218
2017	Q2	\$44,333	\$14,400	\$6,558	\$9,197	68.0%	\$14,178
2017	Q3	\$70,027	\$17,635	\$8,583	\$12,160	54.8%	\$31,649
2017	Q4	\$104,193	\$20,378	\$9,819	\$15,309	43.7%	\$58,688
2017	Q5 - Highest	\$183,291	\$27,147	\$12,875	\$22,843	34.3%	\$120,426
2019	Q1 - Lowest	\$21,579	\$11,892	\$5,545	\$5,555	106.5%	-\$1,413
2019	Q2	\$48,239	\$14,600	\$7,932	\$8,272	63.9%	\$17,435
2019	Q3	\$76,790	\$18,588	\$9,828	\$12,580	53.4%	\$35,794
2019	Q4	\$114,757	\$22,548	\$12,664	\$16,225	44.8%	\$63,320
2019	Q5 - Highest	\$202,891	\$30,934	\$15,610	\$21,721	33.6%	\$134,626
2021	Q1 - Lowest	\$26,471	\$12,704	\$6,175	\$5,182	90.9%	\$2,411
2021	Q2	\$53,178	\$14,943	\$7,591	\$6,572	54.7%	\$24,073
2021	Q3	\$84,244	\$19,185	\$9,600	\$9,894	45.9%	\$45,566
2021	Q4	\$125,766	\$24,992	\$12,409	\$12,844	40.0%	\$75,521
2021	Q5 - Highest	\$225,360	\$30,446	\$15,744	\$16,944	28.0%	\$162,227

Table 16. Essential Burden by Income Quintile

A3. Bootstrap Confidence Intervals — Shelter Burden

Year	Segment	Estimate	SE	CI Lower	CI Upper	95% CI
2017	Q1 - Lowest	53.6%	2.75	48.2%	59.0%	48.2% – 59.0%
2017	Q5 - Highest	14.8%	0.51	13.8%	15.8%	13.8% – 15.8%
2017	British Columbia	24.8%	1.18	22.4%	27.1%	22.4% – 27.1%
2017	Renter	26.5%	0.88	24.8%	28.2%	24.8% – 28.2%
2017	Owner with a mortgage	25.4%	0.67	24.1%	26.7%	24.1% – 26.7%
2019	Q1 - Lowest	55.1%	1.90	51.4%	58.8%	51.4% – 58.8%
2019	Q5 - Highest	15.2%	0.37	14.5%	16.0%	14.5% – 16.0%
2019	British Columbia	25.0%	0.70	23.6%	26.4%	23.6% – 26.4%
2019	Renter	26.2%	0.62	24.9%	27.4%	24.9% – 27.4%
2019	Owner with a mortgage	24.0%	0.39	23.3%	24.8%	23.3% – 24.8%
2021	Q1 - Lowest	48.0%	2.46	43.2%	52.8%	43.2% – 52.8%
2021	Q5 - Highest	13.5%	0.36	12.8%	14.2%	12.8% – 14.2%
2021	British Columbia	23.3%	0.81	21.7%	24.9%	21.7% – 24.9%
2021	Renter	24.0%	0.75	22.6%	25.5%	22.6% – 25.5%
2021	Owner with a mortgage	24.2%	0.46	23.3%	25.2%	23.3% – 25.2%

Table 17. Bootstrap Confidence Intervals — Shelter Burden